

Shopping



Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
Modal Verbs	**Discussing Shopping**
Making assumptions	Types of shops in English
Making requests	Types of Shopping
Too & Enough	**Shopping Vocabulary**
	In the sales
	At the shop
	Clothes and accessories

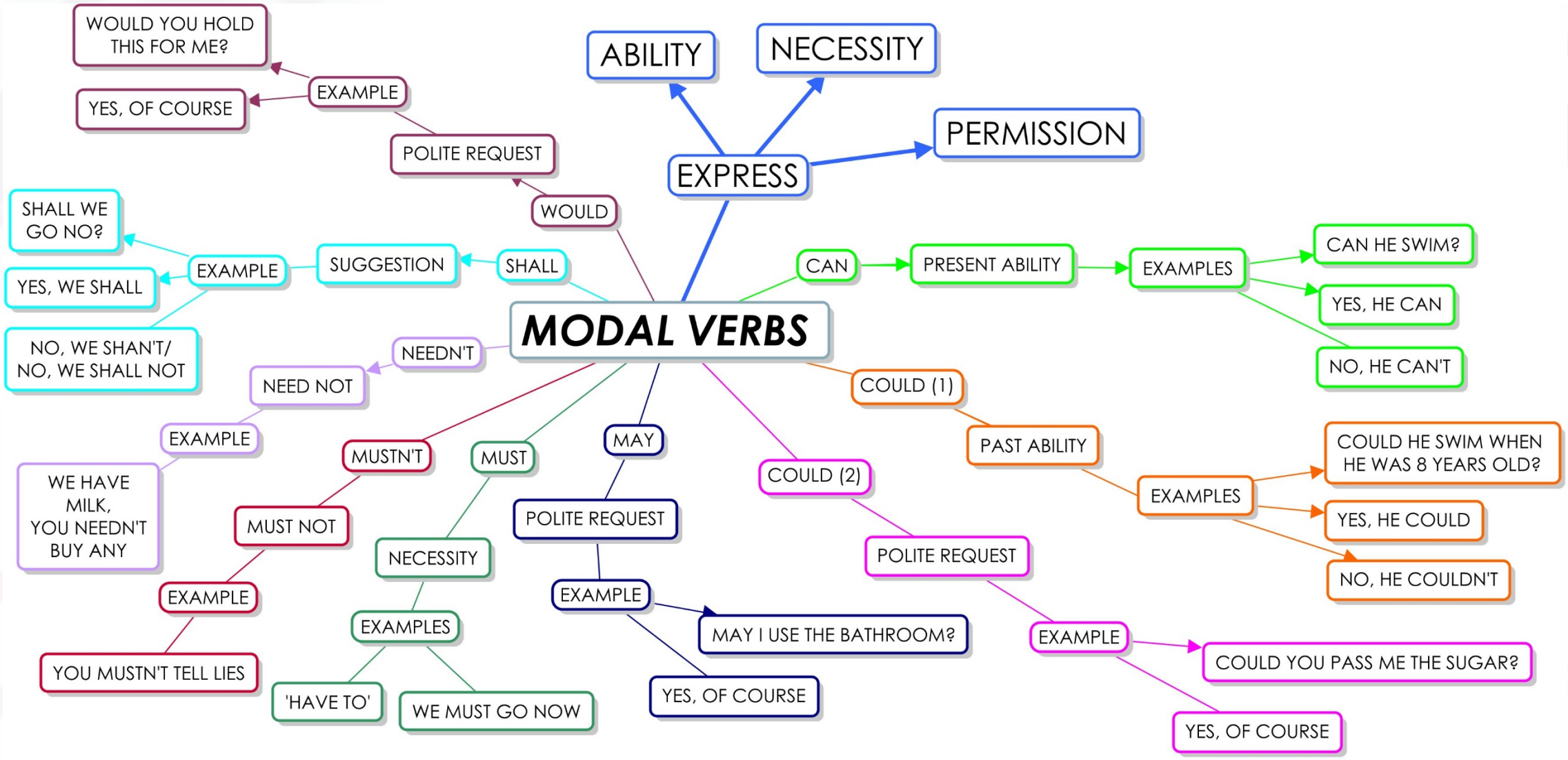
Modal Verbs

A modal is a type of auxiliary (or "helping") verb that is used to express: **ability**, **possibility**, **permission** or **obligation**.

Modals are **always followed by the bare infinitive.**
Modal phrases (or semi-modals) are used to express the same things as modals, but are a combination of auxiliary verbs and the **preposition to**.

The modals and semi-modals in English are:

Modals (modal + bare infinitive)	Semi-Modals (auxiliary verb + to + infinitive)
Can / could May / might Shall / should Must Will / would	Be able to Ought to Have to Need to


MODAL VERBS
EXPRESS
ABILITY
NECESSITY
PERMISSION
CAN
PRESENT ABILITY
EXAMPLES
CAN HE SWIM?
YES, HE CAN
NO, HE CAN'T
COULD (1)
PAST ABILITY
EXAMPLES
COULD HE SWIM WHEN HE WAS 8 YEARS OLD?
YES, HE COULD
NO, HE COULDN'T
COULD (2)
POLITE REQUEST
EXAMPLE
COULD YOU PASS ME THE SUGAR?
YES, OF COURSE
MAY
POLITE REQUEST
EXAMPLE
MAY I USE THE BATHROOM?
YES, OF COURSE
MUST
NECESSITY
EXAMPLES
'HAVE TO'
WE MUST GO NOW
MUSTN'T
MUST NOT
EXAMPLE
YOU MUSTN'T TELL LIES
NEEDN'T
NEED NOT
EXAMPLE
WE HAVE MILK, YOU NEEDN'T BUY ANY
SHALL
SUGGESTION
EXAMPLE
SHALL WE GO NO?
YES, WE SHALL
NO, WE SHAN'T/ NO, WE SHALL NOT
WOULD
POLITE REQUEST
EXAMPLE
WOULD YOU HOLD THIS FOR ME?
YES, OF COURSE

Modal Verbs of Assumption

We can use the following modal verbs (also called modals of assumption, deduction, speculation or certainty) when we want to **make an assumption or deduction** (DEDUZIONE) about something.
We choose the verb depending on how sure we are.

When we are talking about the present, we use: must / might / could / may / can't + infinitive

Example:

You are waiting for Mark with another friend, Paul.
You ask: 'Where is Mark?'
Paul says: He **must be** on the bus. (Paul is 99% sure he is on the bus - HE IS VERY SURE)
He **might** come soon. (Paul is 50% sure - HE THINKS IT'S POSSIBLE)
He **could** be lost. (Paul is 50% sure - HE THINKS IT'S POSSIBLE)
He **may** be on the wrong bus. (Paul is 50% sure - HE THINKS IT'S POSSIBLE)
He **can't** be at home. (Paul is 99% sure he isn't at home - HE THINKS IT'S IMPOSSIBLE)

Notice that the opposite of **must** is **can't** in this case.

Modal Verbs of Assumption

❖ **Will / won't**

We use will and won't + bare infinitive when we are very sure. We are about 80% sure:

She'll be at work now.
He won't be at the airport, yet.

❖ **Should / shouldn't**

Should and shouldn't + bare infinitive are used to make an assumption about what is probably true, if everything is going as we expect. We are about 70% sure:

They should be here by now.
It shouldn't take long to drive there.

Should **isn't usually used for undesirable events**. Use will instead:
The underground will be very busy now (not **should be**, because this is a undesirable event).

Modal Verbs of Assumption

Can

Can + bare infinitive is used for **something that is generally possible**, something we know often happens. We are almost 90% sure:

Prices can be high in London.

Can is **not used** to talk about **specific possibilities**:

He could be on the bus (**not can be**).

Modal Verbs for Making Requests

Modal verbs are used in English to **make polite requests**.

Can & Could

❖ Can and Could are modal verbs used to make requests. Here is the structure:
Can/Could + Subject + bare infinitive

Examples:
Can you pass me the sugar please?

Could you bring your laptop tomorrow?

❖ Can and Could are used differently. **Can is less polite than Could**.

❖ Can is used to make **basic requests** from, for example, a friend or relative. It is often used for small things.
Can you call your brother, please?

Can you call your brother, please?

❖ **Could is more polite than Can, but has the same function:**
Could you call your brother, please?

Could you call your brother, please?

Modal Verbs for Making Requests

May

May is similar to **Could** but it is even more polite, and also a little old-fashioned, so it is not used as often. The structure is the same as Can/Could:

May + Subject + bare infinitive

May I make an appointment for Friday afternoon? – Yes, you may.

May I use the toilet? – Of course.

May I have a cup of coffee? – Sure, here you are.

Modal Verbs for Making Requests

Would

❖ **Would** is also used to **make polite requests** in English. The structure is as follows:
Would you mind + base form + ING

Examples:
Would you mind closing the window?

Would you mind turning down the music?

❖ You can also say **do you mind**, but **would you mind is more polite**:

Do you mind turning off the radio?

Would you mind turning off the radio?

❖ You could also use the structure:
Would you mind + IF + subject + Past Simple:

Examples:
Would you mind if I opened the window?

Would you mind if I turned down the music?

Modal Verbs for Making Requests

❖ **Would** can also be used to make **polite requests** with the verb **like**.

I would like another cup of tea please.

I would like some help with my Maths homework please.

This is the same as using the verb **want**. However, **would** is more polite.

I want a cup of tea (*not very polite*)

I would like a cup of tea (*more polite*)

❖ These types of requests are more common **when ordering something**.

Examples:

I would like potatoes with my steak.

I would like another glass of wine please.

The question form is:

Would you like…?

Would you like potatoes with your steak?

Would you like another glass of wine?

Too & Enough

Too takes on the sense of **too much**, **excessive**, if combined with an **adjective** or an **adverb** and an **infinitive**.

❖ The most common pattern in this type of sentence is:
Too + adjective / adverb + infinitive

It's too cold to go outside.
I'm too tired to come with you (I'm excessively tired)

She tried too hard to impress her teacher.

❖ We can use too + adjective + infinitive to explain **why a specific action cannot be done**:
Mark is too young to drive

10 km is too far to walk

We use **too** + adjective / adverb + **for** somebody
This box is too heavy for you to carry

That sweater is too big for me

Too & Enough

Enough means **sufficient** and we can use it in various ways:

❖ Adjective / adverb + enough + infinitive
He's smart enough to pass
She was fast enough to win
Is your room warm enough ? (is your room sufficiently warm?)

❖ Enough + plural noun
I've got enough books to study on (I've got a sufficient number of books)

❖ Enough + uncountable noun
We haven't got enough money (the money we have is not sufficient)

In this case, **if enough is placed after the name**, the sentence takes on a *formal tone*.
We haven't got money enough to buy that house

❖ We use adjective + **enough for** somebody/something
The road isn't wide enough for both cars to pass
Let's go. We have waited long enough for Silvia